

Responsive Web Development: A Revolutionary Way of Creating Web Designs



Considering the number of different-sized devices available today, crafting websites to provide uniformly optimal viewing and an interaction experience that ensures easy reading and navigation with a minimum of resizing, panning and scrolling is the need of the hour. This is where responsive Web development comes in.

The world of electronic display devices, like mobiles, is expanding by leaps and bounds. On the one hand it gives us, the users, more and more options to view the same content. And on the other hand, it gives Web developers sleepless nights. Because now, their designs must provide an optimal viewing experience on an ever-increasing set of platforms, devices, browsers, resolutions, etc.

Today, every client of a Web developer wants a mobile version of the website, because it is the need of the hour. One design for BlackBerry, another one for iPhones, and others for iPads, Kindles, Android phones, and so on. And all those versions must be compatible with various resolutions.

But in the rapidly changing world of mobile devices where screen sizes, pixel resolutions and browser technologies are changing every day, we have reached a stage where it is practically impossible and impractical to create or manage different versions for different resolutions and

varying sets of devices.

The responsive Web design (RWD) approach is a one-stop solution to end this madness of creating different versions of the same design to support various viewing devices and resolutions. It is inspired by the idea of responsive architecture, wherein physical space can respond to the presence of people passing through it. Ethan Marcotte, a renowned Web technologist, wrote an introductory article called 'A List Apart' about the approach. Transplanting the same discipline on to Web design, we can arrive at a similar but a whole new approach of designing self-adjustable Web designs according to the viewing device.

By definition, responsive Web design is an approach to designing a website such that it gives optimal viewing, and an interaction experience that ensures easy reading and navigation with minimum resizing, panning and scrolling across a wide range of devices.